

TikTok

# The TikTok Effect: Accelerating Southeast Asia's Businesses, Education and Community

How creativity and joy spark growth in SEA



# CEO's Letter

15 June 2023

## To Our TikTok Community,

Today, we are celebrating our mission to inspire creativity and bring joy. We're honored to be a home for more than 325 million people in Southeast Asia (SEA) who come to TikTok every month. Creators, small business owners, consumers, educators and students use TikTok as a window to the world to learn and discover, a canvas to create their own content, and a bridge between individuals and communities.

We surveyed over 3,400 TikTok users across nine countries and 25 leaders representing local non-profit organizations (NPOs) to understand how TikTok is creating real world opportunities. **We've empowered businesses to shift from traditionally offline marketing channels to meet new customers online.** In our survey, 79% of businesses said that TikTok has helped them transition from offline to online marketing channels. **We've helped people find new income sources.** 93% of the creators we surveyed in the region said TikTok provides them a platform to monetize their skills and experience. **We've made learning on TikTok more enjoyable and relatable**. 90% of users who come to TikTok to learn are gaining new skills through content on the platform. In collaboration with local NPOs we've brought onto the platform, **we've made wellness help more accessible** and given our users a safe space to share their lived experiences.

## How We Support the Region's Creators, Businesses and Communities

We are humbled to see the ways that TikTok has made an impact on people's lives, from enabling their livelihoods to strengthening communities of support. Nitchakran Niyhaitwatchanchai turned to TikTok to establish a 26-year-old salad dressing company's online presence in Thailand (page 6). Yan Piset's family-owned crayfish farm in Cambodia quadrupled in size in just six months thanks to its TikTok channel (page 7). Asher Low who runs a Singapore-based wellness NPO, Limitless, leveraged TikTok to reach out to vulnerable youth and encourage them to seek help. Today, over a dozen youths reach out to Limitless each week. In Indonesia, short-form child protection videos by the NPO SEJIWA Foundation (Semai Jiwa Amini) have helped almost 200 youths in need (page 29).

To scale the TikTok effect, we partner with public and private sectors and expand our efforts to empower communities that may face limited access to digital resources and opportunities.

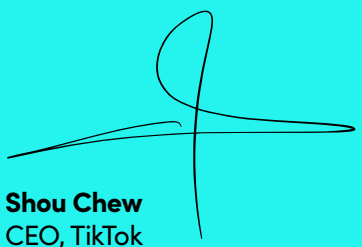
**Our focus is simple: Use TikTok to do good.**

## Continuing our Journey

Looking back at our journey in SEA, we continue to learn daily from the creativity of this immensely diverse community. From Indonesian music artists building their careers to Vietnamese villagers across 63 provinces proudly promoting their local specialities through TikTok Shop, our desire to build on these success stories is stronger than ever.

TikTok is much more than an entertainment platform. It is a place where people can have fun, be creative and feel safe. We are grateful for all the partnerships we have forged, the conversations we have had, and the support we have received all round.

We look forward to continuing on our journey toward building a safe and entertaining space for more people and communities across the region and around the world. Thank you for your support!



**Shou Chew**
CEO, TikTok

# The Evolution of the Creator Economy



It's never been easier to express yourself creatively and to find an audience. It's never been easier to learn, and to teach. And it's never been easier to join and belong to a community.

That is because we have new tools to connect us. New digital and mobile technologies have given rise to a new creator economy that is expected to reach USD21.1 billion by the end of 2023[1].

In SEA, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Vietnam are evolving into digital economies. TikTok is part of the story. It has expanded opportunities for income earning, education and community-building for more than 325 million monthly active users in the region.

For our first SEA socio-economic report, TikTok conducted extensive research to examine the platform's regional impact in three key areas:

### Unlocking Opportunities for Everyone

TikTok connects everyday people with real-world economic opportunities, turning aspirations into achievements. The region's small and medium-sized businesses and creators have expanded their audience reach on TikTok, growing their income and networks.

### Broadening Access to Education and Self-Improvement

TikTok inspires discovery and learning by providing everyone with a window to the world. The region's educators and learners have turned to TikTok as a knowledge-sharing platform to facilitate teaching and learning.

### Building Communities of Support

TikTok helps people find their communities by empowering people of all backgrounds to share their authentic experiences. To support these communities, TikTok actively collaborates with NPOs to provide users with essential self-care tools and resources, such as access to helplines.

1. Source: Statista, Global Influencer Market Size, 2019 (https://influencermarketinghub.com/influencer-marketing-benchmark-report/)

# Unlocking Opportunities for Everyone



# The Creator Economy Connects and Empowers SEA

Businesses have seen the power of the new Creator Economy. They have turned to the digital world to connect with and serve this dynamic, global audience. Brands now collaborate with independent creators on short-form videos that deliver compelling, authentic stories and cultivate valuable brand affinity.

It's a virtuous cycle. As brands welcomed collaboration and community-centric marketing, creators rode the wave by monetizing their content on digital platforms.

Both businesses and creators use TikTok's unique recommendation system to reach target audiences. TikTok makes it easier to tell brand stories with user-friendly content creation tools and resources.

Additionally, initiatives such as "Grow with TikTok: Starter Lab" have provided hands-on, interactive education for small and medium-sized businesses in SEA to build expertise as advertisers, and grow their businesses on the platform. TikTok has partnered with local governments and industry groups across the region to foster the growth of small and medium-sized businesses, such as collaborations with Thailand's Digital Economy Promotion Agency, Indonesia's state-owned enterprise Pertamina and the Vietnam E-commerce Association.

Meanwhile, established businesses in SEA have used the TikTok Creative Exchange[2], TikTok Creator Marketplace[3] and TikTok Branded Mission[4] offerings to connect advertisers, brands and users.

The Creator Economy has set the stage for creators and liberated the resources they need to earn an income by sharing their authentic experiences with the world.

With lowered barriers to entry in digital marketing, SEA's people and businesses are now empowered to embrace digital transformation in order to fully leverage the opportunities presented to them.



2. Source: TikTok Creative Exchange (https://ads.tiktok.com/creativeexchange/)
3. Source: TikTok Creator Marketplace (https://creatormarketplace.tiktok.com/)
4. Source: TikTok Branded Mission (https://www.tiktok.com/business/en-US/blog/branded-mission-topview-cpm-top-feed)



# “TikTok is the best marketplace.”

**Regina Oktaviana**
Indonesia
@oktaviana_tas_grosir

## A New Fashion Icon

Need a handbag? Live in Indonesia? Regina Oktaviana has got you covered.

Oktaviana Tas Grosir (Wholesale Bags by Oktaviana) is an emerging fashion powerhouse, and not just because Oktaviana has created the perfect blend of fashion and affordability. She has also tapped into a community eager to interact with her unique brand and message.

Oktaviana uses a range of TikTok’s tools to engage with her three million TikTok followers. They interact with her LIVE videos where she showcases the handbags on sale, and shop for handbags on her TikTok Shop.

Oktaviana has taken full advantage of Video Shopping Ads and Live Shopping Ads, broadly targeting adult women in Indonesia with fast-paced and engaging content that leads to a seamless purchase experience.

Her extremely efficient advertising – for every dollar spent on advertising, she earns 28 times the amount invested – also allows her to support her community by opening up jobs, creating a reseller program for female entrepreneurs and, most recently, by expanding her business network with three new warehouses. “It’s still not enough!” Oktaviana says about her fast-growing fashion empire.

**79%** of businesses were supported by TikTok in transitioning from offline to online marketing channels

**74%** of businesses surveyed who use TikTok for Business increased their sales volume

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)





"TikTok is our strategic partner whose powerful platform enables businesses like ours to reach new audiences hungry for our products and eager to use them in new ways."

**Nitchakran Niyhaitwatchanchai**
Thailand
@purefoodsthailand



## A Sweet Taste of Success

For 26 years, Thailand-based Purefoods has made some of the Land of Smiles' finest low-calorie salad dressings, mayonnaises and sauces. But Vice President Nitchakran Niyhaitwatchanchai had a vision to launch the company into a new digital world, to reach and secure new customers, and fulfill its mission to put at least one of its products in every Thai home.

An active TikTok user, she saw the high growth potential for Purefoods to use the platform to spread the word about her delicious goods to new audiences. So, she posted a series of short-form videos showing people how to prepare delicious meals using Purefoods' products to cook up more brand awareness.

Tapping into TikTok's easy-to-use creative tools, Niyhaitwatchanchai's TikTok campaign helped Purefoods gain more than 400,000 followers and 100,000 likes in less than three months. Engagement also boiled over in Purefoods' TikTok comments section, where hungry viewers and buyers organically started conversations to share cooking tips, recipes and successful meals.

Now, Purefoods' TikTok fans can't wait to see what Niyhaitwatchanchai and her company serve up next.

**96%**

of businesses surveyed gained new customers after using TikTok

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)

"Many people contacted me after discovering me on TikTok to buy baby crayfish."



## Growing a Local Farming Business

Yan Piset, 26, has 128,000 followers on TikTok. On his account, he talks about crayfish and crayfish farming. His only route to market is his digital content.

Yan started his hyper-local business in 2019 with five ponds. He has 20 now, producing more than 500kg of crayfish a day that he sells to customers and restaurants in adjoining provinces. He says 50 to 100 new customers find him via his TikTok channel each month.

Breakout videos, like a 15-second viral clip that has generated more than 2.5 million views, led to steadily growing sales. Six months after starting his TikTok channel, he generated about USD2,000 in monthly profit. Sales continue to grow. As he says, "Many people have contacted me to buy crayfish after discovering me on TikTok. I have received support from customers in Phnom Penh. Sometimes I get orders from seafood vendors as well."

Yan has ambitious growth plans. He says he hopes to eventually have a crayfish farm in every province to get his product closer to his customers for faster delivery.

**Yan Piset**
Cambodia
@yanpiset

**94%**
of businesses surveyed who use TikTok as a platform for sales increased their sales orders

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)





# “In TikTok, I found my passion in life and direction for what I wanted to do.”

**Jessica Rose**
The Philippines
@nanayjecka

## Finding Life and Career Rebirth After Postpartum Depression

Like nearly 20%[5] of new mothers in the Philippines, 28-year-old working mum and baker Jessica Rose experienced postpartum depression and wrestled with feelings of underachievement. But by reaching out to others who share her experiences on TikTok, she found support and birthed a new level of financial success.

Rose’s TikTok journey began when she noticed an increase in brand requests for her content. However, she was new to video editing and found it challenging to create content. She forged on nonetheless, inspired to help and learn from other creator mums.

She found a community of creators who banded together, and who captured the attention of different brands through the hashtag #TikTokMomPH. They shared tips and tricks on navigating motherhood, parenting and making videos. Within this community, she gained more brand deals and earned between USD2,000 and USD3,000 a month – enough to leave her full-time job and pursue her passion as a baker and full-time creator.

But the icing on the cake is her renewed passion for content creation that brought her new life and energy during her postpartum depression. She is empowered now to help and inspire other mums like herself. Her new sweet spot is giving back to the community and deepening her support for others.



**94%** of content creators surveyed agreed that TikTok provided an opportunity to create content and earn money beyond the means of traditional media

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)

5. Source: National Library of Medicine, Predictors of postpartum depression and the utilization of postpartum depression services in rural areas in the Philippines, 2019 (https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/31355473/)



# “TikTok has had a big impact on my life. Thanks to TikTok I had a chance to do my second movie.”

## Nguyễn Tô Ngọc Diễm
Vietnam
@ybcgroup12

## Launching an Acting Career

When Vietnam went into lockdown in 2020 as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic, Nguyễn Tô Ngọc Diễm’s modeling and acting career hit a wall.

While staying indoors, she and her husband started to create their own original content. “We created TikTok videos. We didn’t have much equipment, so we kept our recording and editing simple. No animation, no effects.”

Her simple content highlighted her talent, and it paid off. Brands and agencies came across her content and joined her growing TikTok community.

Today, Nguyễn is frequently approached for new casting and job opportunities. Her earnings have nearly tripled, and her family is better supported and more stable. She can now work on self-development projects she could not devote the time to before. She says she has experienced “true transformation,” and is looking forward to her next role.

**95%**

were able to learn new creative techniques from other content creators

Among respondents who use TikTok Creator Marketplace,

**85%**

secured new brand sponsorships

**89%**

said TikTok was effective in promoting their content

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)



# Expanding Opportunities

These case studies represent creators and businesses in SEA who have used TikTok's tools to boost their incomes, deeply engage with other users and widen their audience reach.

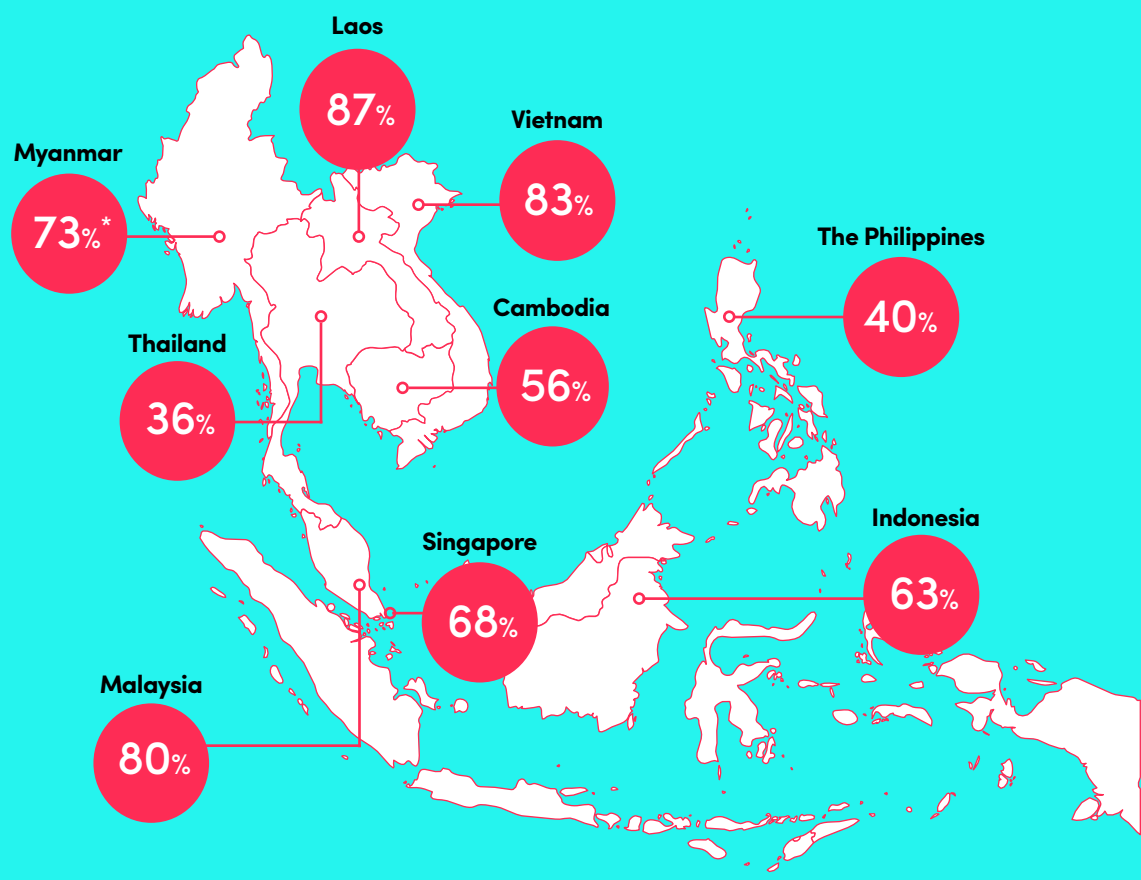
TikTok empowers creators to monetize their skills and passions. TikTok creators have seized opportunities to earn a living or supplement their incomes through brand partnerships, livestreaming, affiliate marketing and many other revenue opportunities. They have used TikTok as a storytelling platform to expand their influence in authentic, entertaining and engaging ways.

## New Income Streams

In SEA, more than 80% of TikTok creators have boosted their incomes through multiple avenues, such as earning through TikTok LIVE or working with brands through paid sponsorships, according to our regional survey.

Among polled creators who use TikTok as a source of income, most are earning more than the minimum wage in their respective nations, according to our survey data.

**Percentage of surveyed creators earning more than minimum wage on TikTok in SEA**




Additionally, 93% of SEA creators believed TikTok is a platform where they can monetize their skills and 86% said they used TikTok to increase traffic to their other social media platforms.

Small and medium-sized SEA businesses had similar success, increasing their revenues by nearly 50% after using TikTok to sell their products and services.

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)

*Low base (<n=30): Myanmar (n=26)

Minimum wages (in USD) for SEA markets fielded are as follows: Malaysia (279), Vietnam (158), Laos (116), Philippines (177), Myanmar (61), Singapore (2078), Indonesia (216), Cambodia (192), Thailand (208). As there is no minimum wage in Singapore, the figure is derived from LKYSPP's study for a reasonable living wage in Singapore, calculated using a Minimum Income Standard (MIS) method (based on an average budget for households with two adults and two children in contiguous age bands, assuming both parents work full-time while taking into account taxes and major benefits). Source: **ASEAN Briefing** and **Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy (LKYSPP)**

# Expanding Audience Reach

Many businesses use TikTok to reach a wide range of audiences with their target profile.

**93%**
of businesses surveyed reached the right target audience

Businesses leverage TikTok's tools and features to equip themselves with more knowledge to grow their brands. In fact, TikTok helped more than 80% of businesses gain business capital for further expansion:

Among businesses who use TikTok Ads Manager,

**80%**
effectively promoted their business

Among businesses who use TikTok Business Center,

**83%**
said the feature made their marketing processes more efficient

# More Collaboration and Engagement

Home to digital creatives around the world, TikTok is a collaborative platform for creators to learn from one another and forge brand partnerships.

To empower the creator community, TikTok launched its Creator Marketplace to help creators and brands reach out and connect to create partnerships.

**94%**
of creators surveyed thought that TikTok helped to increase engagement with their target audiences

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)

# Broadening Access to Education and Self-Improvement



The sum total of all human knowledge may be a click away in this digital era, but education still requires guidance: students need teachers and teachers need supportive communities.

More people can teach and reach new students, and even more students have access to learning resources, thanks to wide-reaching networks and mobile devices, and technologies that allow students and teachers to be connected.

Nowhere is this more evident than in SEA, where virtual schools and digital tools bridge multicultural and geographic divides to share and spread knowledge and help people explore new skills and interests.



In April 2022, TikTok Indonesia launched a youth-focused education campaign, **#SerunyaBelajar** (#TheJoyofLearning). It showcased a wide variety of educational-based content focused on self-development and betterment. The local hashtags #SerunyaBelajar and #SamaSamaBelajar currently have more than 27.7 billion and 104.7 billion views on TikTok, respectively. Users have submitted more than 871,000 videos and the LIVE sessions garnered more than 3.9 million viewers.



Vietnam's **#LearnOnTikTok** hashtag started in June 2020 and has grown into the biggest umbrella hashtag for all informative content on the platform. More than 1,000 creators have contributed content leading to more than 157 billion video views in Vietnam.



In Malaysia, the education and learning community is rapidly expanding. **#TikTokGuru** is one of the most used hashtags with more than 1.1 million interactive videos. In addition, #TikTokGuru video views have grown from 14.3 billion views in 2022 to 24.7 billion views as of early 2023.



Singapore's **#LearningIsFun** campaign shows how the appetite for educational content on TikTok continues to grow. Between February 2020 and January 2021, the number of educational videos on the platform increased by more than 38 times, and #LearningisFun videos received over 344 million views.



**#TikTokUni** – the platform's first educational campaign in Thailand – launched in 2020 to drive informative content and inspire creators. The three-year campaign changed perceptions of TikTok from a dancing-and-singing app, to an edutainment platform amongst users, creators, government stakeholders, and business and media partners. #TikTokUni had more than 203 billion views in Thailand in early 2023.



Supplementing other popular education hashtags in Philippines, TikTok launched the **#LearnItOnTikTok** campaign in October 2022. Within six months, there were 2.8 million #LearnItOnTikTok educational videos racking up 6.5 billion video views.



Educational content creators, teachers, students and curious learners have flocked to various TikTok learning communities, such as #LifeHacks, #CleanTok, #BookTok and more.

**#LifeHacks** has more than 82 billion views globally with users sharing useful hacks to make life easier, from food hacks to beauty hacks and others.

**#CleanTok** has more than 70 billion views globally with videos ranging from deep-clean tips to recommendations of best cleaning products.

**#BookTok** continues to thrive on the platform with more than 119 billion views globally catering to individuals who provide book recommendations, organize book clubs and more.

From arranging flowers and learning an instrument to pursuing academic studies and developing skills outside the classroom, TikTok empowers users to learn from experts, scholars and hobbyists. It fosters a participatory community to broaden learners' horizons.

## Cultivating Creativity and Innovation

TikTok enables educators to diversify their teaching methods to reach audiences across wide geographies. Even in secondary cities where infrastructural support is less conducive for online learning and teaching, educators use the platform to teach and overcome challenges they could not have in the past.

Captivating short-form content, a recommendation system that promotes relevant content and initiatives to support education, make TikTok an invaluable and accessible learning resource. It inspires discovery and learning by providing everyone with a window to the world, digitally connecting students, educators and creators to create a conducive learning space for all.

Education's digital revolution is here to stay, and SEA users have embraced the opportunity to learn autonomously and innovatively to better their academic, professional and personal lives.





**Clark Anthony**
The Philippines
@anthonytrovela97

**“TikTok has really innovated the way people learn... it is able to introduce technical concepts which can be simplified.”**

## Expanding the Virtual Classroom

Teachers across SEA work hard to prepare their students to become better versions of themselves, steer them toward their vocations and arm them with the knowledge they will need to be successful in the 21st century. But some students need an extra helping hand outside the classroom.

Filipino Clark Anthony’s learning journey on TikTok started when he came across #EduTok, one of the educational hashtags used in the Philippines. The 25-year-old researcher wanted to pay it forward and began producing TikTok videos to make research more approachable for high school and college students, especially those who were apprehensive about research.

He averages 100,000 views per video. Many of his viewers share stories about passing research modules or defending them robustly using advice from his videos, which inspires him to continue to share his knowledge on TikTok. With #EduTok’s support, he says he hopes to build a broader community of Filipino creators across all subjects to help students across the region.





**Sashwenii A/P Kovindan**
Malaysia

**81%**
of learners surveyed felt TikTok helped them learn academic lessons

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)

## From Subject Failure to Mastery

Twenty-year-old Sashwenii A/P Kovindan in Malaysia struggled in school and was failing her mathematics class despite getting additional tutoring. She turned to TikTok and started to engage with a supportive academic community, discovering numerous educational content creators who offered informative and helpful tips. She says their short-form content was a "life-changer."

She was able to concentrate and learn more effectively on the platform and saw a remarkable improvement in her grades. She went from failing her Sijil Pelajaran Malaysia (a national high school examination) to earning a B+.

She, like thousands of others in the region, has found the academic support she needed during a difficult time and blossomed in a new space for discovery and learning.



**Prayut Phusangsri**
Thailand




## Revving up Sales Through New Skills

Everyone's career journey is different. Some find mentors, while others are self-taught or university-educated. But they can all learn more, perfect their craft and shift their vocation into higher gears.

SEA TikTok users have joined communities to support them on their quests to learn and pursue their vocations. People across the region have found easy and entertaining ways to grow their skill sets or cultivate new ones by tapping into TikTok's short, captivating content from creators who share lessons, tips and resources on a virtually endless variety of subjects and career paths.



For example, take Thailand's Prayut Phusangsri. The 45-year-old car sales supervisor had the technical knowledge one can only get through decades of experience in the automotive industry. But even he wasn't trained or prepared to sell cars during a global pandemic that made it nearly impossible to find and win over potential customers.

Driven to overcome the COVID-19 pandemic's challenges, he joined TikTok, found sales-training content and quick tips, then supercharged his techniques to better anticipate customers' needs and generate more leads and sales.

During the pandemic, he averaged three to five car sales a month. Now, he has nearly doubled his monthly sales numbers even as the number of customers has remained consistent.

"The techniques I got from TikTok helped me close deals," Phusangsri said. "Now I know how to best pitch and present my products to raise my chances of closing a sale."



**Anisara Xayakone**
Laos

## Creating More Opportunities by Design

In Laos, 19-year-old Anisara Xayakone found inspiration and direction for her newfound passion. After joining TikTok in 2019, she gravitated towards design tutorials in her feed. With her iPad ready and a host of creators sharing their learning stories, she began to educate herself in design.

She streamlined her learning process using TikTok's short-form videos to quickly nurture new skills that led to visible improvement in her work. Anisara is now enrolled in school to pursue a degree in architecture. And as she pursues a post-secondary education, Anisara continues to create and sell her digital artwork while expanding her skills on TikTok.

**86%**

of surveyed learners said that they picked up new industry skills on TikTok for their jobs

**90%**

of surveyed learners said they gained new skills on TikTok which they would not have otherwise

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)





**Thida Oo**
Myanmar
@thidaoojllc

**"My main aim is to... motivate young people who are feeling lost and hopeless to show them that they are able to create opportunities for their lives."**

## Preparing Students for Academic, Professional and Personal Success

TikTok's popularity among SEA's youth has made it an indispensable resource to reach high school students. The platform's editing tools allow the creation of informative content that captures attention. Educators from all backgrounds have tapped in, sharing short and captivating videos to make the platform relevant and innovative for learning.

Thida Oo, an English and Japanese teacher from Myanmar, struggled to find work in her rural town and turned to TikTok when the COVID-19 pandemic forced her to transition to online teaching.

With a focus on making education accessible for all, she crafted simple lessons that have gained more than five million views from a wide audience of urban and rural learners of all ages in Myanmar and beyond. She has inspired students and strangers while connecting with others, learning new skills and finding new motivation for herself.

**84%** of educators surveyed were able to transition to online teaching methods with the help of TikTok

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)



**“TikTok brought educational content creators together, and we all learn on TikTok. TikTok campaigns are about learning together.”**

**Teuka Daffa**
Indonesia
@daffaspeaks

## Finding a Voice and Spreading Confidence

Indonesian Teuka Daffa was motivated to make a difference in his country. The 23-year-old noticed his fellow Indonesians had trouble expressing themselves and began crafting TikTok content to share public speaking advice.

His videos incorporated funny anecdotes and activities, such as a one-minute pitch challenge that gained millions of views. The impact was extraordinary. His viewers shared stories about academic achievements, getting a confidence boost and making successful presentations. They confirmed what he already knew – when young Indonesians develop sound public-speaking skills, conviction and a way to share their strengths with others, they can lead and make a positive impact in their country.



# Learning and Teaching for All



TikTok users have tapped into the platform's diverse educational content to access information and knowledge sometimes not commonly available in their schools to supplement and complement their set curricula. More than 50% of TikTok learners surveyed said the platform enabled online learning during the COVID-19 pandemic induced school closures, and they continue to gravitate to online educational resources.

**61%** of surveyed learners believed TikTok made online learning more accessible

In fact, TikTok has remained their playground for discovery, growth and exploration. A majority of learners said the platform allowed them to learn new skills for work and leisure, as 86% picked up new industry skills for their jobs, and more than 80% said it helped them find new career opportunities.

## A Creative Place for Educators

In recent years, SEA educators have found their own growth opportunities on TikTok. They have used the platform to find new and creative ways to supplement offline learning. Educators on the platform found a vibrant community of like-minded peers and creators to get better at their craft while inspiring their students.

More than 90% of educators surveyed said TikTok helped them learn new ways of teaching from content posted by other educators. Some 80% leveraged the collaborative platform to partner with schools, institutions and other learning platforms, empowering them to not only teach but also learn from one another.

The region's educators also used TikTok to expand their reach. More than 90% of SEA educators surveyed on the platform enjoyed success in connecting with communities beyond their own within the region and around the globe.

**92%** of surveyed educators who used TikTok said they were able to share their knowledge internationally

**94%** of surveyed educators who used TikTok said they were able to reach out to more users through the platform

**91%** of surveyed educators who used TikTok said they were able to promote online learning to youth through the platform

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)

# Building Communities of Support





# Wellness Outreach

The importance of mental health cannot be understated, especially for young people navigating through life's challenges. As awareness around mental health, well-being and inclusion continues to grow around the globe, the TikTok community has also grown to be advocates for these causes by sharing authentic stories and pointing those in need to helpful resources.

A YouGov survey[6] shows nearly a third (31%) of global consumers would feel more comfortable talking about their mental well-being if they were encouraged from a young age to talk about it. With the findings revealing that 18- to 24-year-olds were the least comfortable discussing mental well-being, it is more important than ever to ensure there are mental well-being programs in place for youths.

TikTok is committed to protecting the well-being of its community. TikTok provides updated well-being resources, such as in-app guides and toolkits, backed by research, experts and the community. In 2022, TikTok launched new well-being guides[7] to support people who choose to share their personal experiences on the platform and provided other resources for digital well-being[8]. TikTok also empowers caregivers with resources like the Guardian's Guide[9] to better support their conversations with young users on online safety and well-being.

6. Source: YouGov Report: Global Consumer Attitude on Mental Well-being, 2022 (https://business.yougov.com/sectors/agency/TikTok-consumer-attitude-on-mental-wellbeing)
7. Source: TikTok, Digital well-being guide (https://www.tiktok.com/safety/en/well-being-guide/)
8. Source: TikTok, Guardian's Guide (https://www.tiktok.com/safety/en/guardians-guide/)
9. Source: TikTok, Digital well-being (https://www.tiktok.com/safety/en/well-being/)



TikTok offers a safe place where its community can feel comfortable sharing their personal stories and openly discussing well-being.

Across nine SEA markets, TikTok launched localized, in-app Digital Wellness Hubs in collaboration with local partners. The Digital Wellness Hubs serve as a repository of mental and digital wellness resources, including access to support helplines, as well as wellness content contributed by non-profit partners and TikTok creators to empower users to shape positive digital experiences.

TikTok also partners with public and private sector organizations on meaningful campaigns and programs to promote mental and digital well-being. Highlights include:

## Indonesia

To commemorate World Mental Health Day, TikTok launched the #SeeingtheUnseen[10] campaign to encourage open conversations that destigmatize mental health issues. As part of the campaign, TikTok worked with renowned celebrity and bipolar disorder survivor, Marshanda, whose art continues to dispel misconceptions about mental health.

## Singapore

Working with government and non-profit partners, TikTok embarked on a series of flagship mental and cyber wellness programs for youth and NPOs. Through the Youth for Good[11] and ELEVATE programs, TikTok has empowered youth as peer supporters and equipped participants with the tools, resources and platform to build a better and safer online space where vulnerable users are able to access support ecosystems. Today, TikTok's passionate wellness community compromising more than 40 youth and more than 40 NPOs continue to use their voices for good.

## Thailand

As part of the #ดูแลใจไปด้วยกัน[12] (#TakeCareTogether) TikTok ran a talkshow event featuring a psychiatrist from the Department of Mental Health of Thailand (@thaidmh) as well as creators Eve Tsu (@eve_tsu) and Watcharapon Nonpakdee (@papaparty_feelgood) to discuss perspectives on mental health, including coping and prevention strategies. In addition, TikTok collaborated with SatiApp (@satiapp), a mental health and self-care app, as well as personalities such as Amanda Obdam, Miss Universe Thailand (@amanda.obdam) and Koen Danai (@koendanai), a famous artist and psychotherapist, to raise awareness about mental health and well-being.

10. Source: Seeing the Unseen | TikTok Indonesia, 2022 (https://youtu.be/xXXZ6ONnQew)
11. Source: TikTok Newsroom, Youth for good (https://newsroom.tiktok.com/en-sg/youth-for-good-2-sg)
12. Source: TikTok (bit.ly/TakeCareTogetherTikTok)

**"TikTok has given me the freedom to express myself, be creative and try new things. There's so much that can be done and explored on this platform and I want to continue using it to do good and shed light on the causes that mean so much to me."**

**Adeline Tay**
Singapore
@adelimey



## Life With and Beyond Alopecia

Adeline Tay's friends always knew her as upbeat, but when she started losing her hair and was diagnosed with alopecia, it took more than her close circle of friends for her to find her joy again.

Fresh out of military basic training with the Singapore Armed Forces Volunteer Corps, Tay found it difficult to adjust to life with alopecia. But then one video on TikTok, about an Asian koel bird visiting her doorstep, turned into a series of educational videos for 35,000 followers when some started asking about her hair. TikTok became a place for Tay to document her reflections, experiences and learnings – from regrowths to relapses.




More recently, a video of her finding the courage to walk around Singapore's bustling Orchard Road helped light a spark within a cancer patient, who decided to take control of her situation and shave off her hair. Many of her followers have also begun educating their peers about alopecia, turning insensitive comments into empathy and opening bigger spaces for inclusivity and diversity. "I never thought that just sharing a video, about me finding the courage to go about my everyday life, could have such an impact on someone else," she says.

Today, Tay embraces her identity as a creator, crediting TikTok for empowering her with easy-to-use tools to produce videos about finding and celebrating the joys of everyday life, even when the going gets tough. She also uses her platform to shine a light on NPOs, helping them to gain recognition and support for the work they do, as part of her ongoing mission to do good and add a touch of positivity to the lives of others.

**92%** of surveyed users who browse wellness content on TikTok were able to gain knowledge about mental well-being from TikTok

**57%** of wellness advocates surveyed used TikTok to connect with users struggling with mental health issues

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)



**"The TikTok community made me realize that society is more open now to people with disabilities and that will create a more equal society for all."**

**Buntida 'Fai' Chinnawong**
Thailand
@faiifaii003

## On Her Feet

Buntida 'Fai' Chinnawong's beauty routine is unlike other makeup artists'. Instead of using her hands to glam herself up, Chinnawong uses only her feet to achieve the final look. Born without arms, and with a passion for makeup, Chinnawong's extraordinary story has been featured in numerous media platforms. She credits TikTok for accelerating her popularity and career growth.

Chinnawong, 23, is a TikTok star. For five years, she has used TikTok exclusively as her digital platform. She says the platform allows her to reach a wide audience, gain new followers easily and share her stories authentically. She has nearly six million followers; her contagious laugh and friendly chitchat attracts up to 10,000 viewers per LIVE session.

With a solid fanbase built on TikTok, Chinnawong was able to launch her own cosmetic brand, Kunfaii Cosmetics. The products are available on her TikTok Shop.

Chinnawong's story-telling strategy of 'show, don't tell' works on TikTok. She has also partnered with a disabilities rights group to campaign for fairer access to public transport, and continues to advocate for people with disabilities. She says, "I just want to show people how I live by using my feet. TikTok has the power to create change. I use it not only for me but for the disability community."





# “When you know more, you can do more. I like that about TikTok.”

**Farisha Firdaus Tajudeen**
Singapore

## Finding Sisterhood As a New Hijabi

Farisha Firdaus Tajudeen was exploring the journey to become a hijabi – a Muslim woman who wears the traditional hijab headscarf – when she joined TikTok.

“The stories from the communities helped me, and I learned a lot,” she said. The TikTok community revealed itself to her amidst a world of valuable information about mental health, mindfulness, spirituality and even fashion.

“The online community complemented my offline circle and supported my spiritual journey”, she said. During the challenging moments of her journey, hearing stories from her TikTok community helped keep her spirits up and encouraged her to persevere in her path to become a hijabi.

She said TikTok brought a magic blend of community, authentic entertainment and resources to help her through her decision. It was what she needed, just when she needed it.

**91%**

of surveyed TikTok users who browse wellness content agree that TikTok helped them find a supportive community of like-minded individuals going through similar issues as them

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)



**"TikTok is our platform of choice for public outreach. We will continue to use it to educate, connect and drive a deeper understanding of mental health in Singapore."**

**Asher Low**
**Limitless**
Singapore
@limitless.sg

## Giving Back, Multiplied

Asher Low is a champion for youths mental health. He started his organization, Limitless, to help youth without a strong in-person support circle find the support they need.

"We want to make it easy for people to get support," Low said. "Part of that is being where young people are - and that's on TikTok." On the platform, Limitless shares content that busts myths about mental health. Limitless is also part of TikTok Singapore's wellness community where it receives training and support for raising awareness of mental health on the platform and reaching out to vulnerable youth.

In Limitless' first weekend on TikTok, more than 150 young people reached out for mental health support, reflecting the demand for community and help. Today, two to three people on average reach out daily, a number Low finds encouraging.

Most NPOs feel TikTok helps to drive greater interest around their causes and is effective at destigmatizing mental health topics.

**93%** of wellness advocates surveyed said they were able to spread messages about mental well-being on TikTok

**92%** of wellness advocates said they reached a broader range of users through TikTok

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)



“Young people are now more motivated to move and ask questions.”

**Diena Haryana**
**SEJIWA Foundation (Semai Jiwa Amini)**
Indonesia
@sejiwa.foundation






## Opening Help-Seeking Channels to Combat Cyberbullying

It takes a community to combat negative online behavior, like cyberbullying and social media addiction. Diena Haryana believes younger users need education about these behaviors, but so do parents and educators. At the SEJIWA Foundation, Haryana created a child protection model that engages all in the community who can help.

The short-form videos are engaging, informative and helpful to all, and so far have opened help-seeking channels to almost 200 clients in need.

Cyberbullying is a topic that was rarely discussed in Indonesia until recently. But in only six months of using TikTok, she has seen some of SEJIWA Foundation’s informational videos reach 40,000 views. It is a good milestone in promoting digital safety for younger people.



# “Wherever the youth are, that’s where we want to be.”

**Srida Tantaatipanit**
**Internet Foundation for the Development of Thailand**
Thailand
@inetfoundation

## Reaching out to Young People and Adults

For 20 years, the Internet Foundation for the Development of Thailand has worked to keep people one step ahead of internet crimes and scams – especially those that target younger users.

Today, the organization trains more than 5,000 people a year, from parents to teachers to social workers at NPOs. To expand its reach to youths directly, and to help them recognize online harm and bad actors, the organization turned to TikTok. The Foundation has supported **100 beneficiaries** since beginning its journey on TikTok, with their videos often reaching more than 10,000 views - some even surpassing 100,000 views.

What’s next? Tantaatipanit says that the Foundation hopes to engage in more partnerships with TikTok to create new campaigns around internet safety and is finding new ways to include young people in their videos to be more relatable.

**88%** of wellness advocates on TikTok surveyed have collaborated with NPOs to increase awareness on wellness topics

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)





**“Advocacy on TikTok works as you have the opportunity to reach vast audiences and connect with the next generation of digital natives.”**

**Nguyen Phuong Linh**
**MSD United Way Vietnam**
Vietnam
@msd.liveunited

## Using TikTok to Create More Kindness

Nguyen Phuong Linh leads MSD United Way in Vietnam (MSD), an NPO that supports the vulnerable: young people, marginalized communities, people with disabilities and women. MSD works with schools, local organizations, parents and, of course, directly with youth via TikTok. “It’s a good channel for youths to participate,” Nguyen says.

MSD is expanding on its previous TikTok campaign, #CreateKindness, to reach new volunteers to run activities around positivity and kindness. TikTok campaigns, Nguyen says, are currently about raising awareness. Intervention comes after outreach.

(Data from TikTok Socio-Economic Impact Study 2022 by Kadence International)

# Alone, Together During COVID-19

When the world closed up during the pandemic, people opened up online.

On digital platforms like TikTok, those who felt under-represented, vulnerable and isolated found a sense of community. They found a place to share their stories, learn from one another and grow with the support of caring and like-minded people they would otherwise never get the chance to connect with.

It started with simple health education programs. For example, in Singapore, TikTok teamed up with the Ministry of Communications and Information (MCI) to make trusted information available about the nationwide vaccination program. MCI successfully reached close to **1 million people** in Singapore, with more than **1,400 videos created and 4 million video views**. The program was instrumental in reaching youths who had questions about vaccine programs.

Regional campaigns included:

**#KhmerVacc** discouraged the spread of fake news by offering factual information about vaccines and by rallying well-known TikTok creators to promote vigilance against misinformation.

**#LawanCovid19** supported Indonesia's fight against COVID-19 with innovative games and created a community of healthcare professionals to engage and educate users on health and vaccine safety.

**#VaccinateLaos** reduced COVID-19 misinformation by guiding users to find fact-based information and official resources about vaccines.

**#KitaJagaKita** supported the country's vaccination drive by encouraging public health experts and healthcare professionals to address TikTok users' biggest questions and concerns in livestreams.

**#Resbakuna** helped users overcome vaccine hesitancy and fear by sharing real stories of people who had received the vaccine.

**#IGotMyShotSG** supported Singapore's nationwide vaccination drive by having TikTok users' questions about vaccines answered by healthcare professionals on TikTok LIVE.

**#SongKhoe247** brought together news partners and healthcare professionals to offer a holistic perspective of how to stay healthy and overcome the pandemic.

Altogether, more than **700,000 educational TikTok videos** were created to engage communities with factual information about vaccines. These videos received more than **8 billion views** in the region.



# In Closing

This report illustrates the value of bringing communities together through shared experiences in Southeast Asia (SEA).

As the digital economy grows in SEA, opportunities abound – from economic gains for individuals and businesses, to innovative ways of teaching and learning online, and a greater sense of belonging for everyone in the community.

TikTok offers programs to help people, organizations, and businesses to unlock opportunities. And we are committed to partner with government and non-profit organizations to support and uplift communities.

Join us in your next efforts.



# Addendum

## Research Methodology

On behalf of TikTok, Kadence International conducted this survey to explore the impact of TikTok across SEA. It was conducted across nine SEA markets and included more than 3,400 TikTok users and 25 non-profit organizations and ran between August and September 2022. The survey used a mixed methodology of both online surveys and offline interviews.

## Quantitative Survey for TikTok Users

A 20-minute online survey was conducted with 500 TikTok users in each SEA market. The same survey was conducted online and offline with 100 TikTok users each in three developing markets*.

| Market | Main Cities | Secondary Cities | Total Sample |
|---|---|---|---|
| Singapore | n=507 | NA | **n=507** |
| Malaysia | n=516 | NA | **n=516** |
| Philippines | n=335 | n=182 | **n=517** |
| Thailand | n=209 | n=303 | **n=512** |
| Indonesia | n=250 | n=290 | **n=540** |
| Vietnam | n=381 | n=126 | **n=507** |
| *Cambodia | n=76 | n=29 | **n=105** |
| *Laos | n=38 | n=66 | **n=104** |
| *Myanmar | n=52 | n=52 | **n=104** |
| | | **TOTAL** | **N=3412** |

## Quantitative Survey for Non-Profit Organizations (NPOs)

A 15-minute online survey was conducted with 25 NPOs who have partnered with TikTok in the region.

| Market | Sample |
|---|---|
| Singapore | **n=15** |
| Philippines | **n=3** |
| Thailand | **n=4** |
| Indonesia | **n=2** |
| Vietnam | **n=1** |
| **TOTAL** | **N=25** |

## Qualitative Surveys

We also conducted qualitative (interview) sessions from July to September 2022. Across nine SEA markets, we spoke to 192 TikTok users, content creators and small and medium-sized businesses, as well as 26 experts at NPOs.

## Qualitative Focus Group Discussions

We spoke to various TikTok user profiles (including small and medium-sized business owners, educators, learners and other users) in small, three-person focus groups. Interviews lasted one to one-and-half hours. The sessions were conducted across nine SEA markets in both main and secondary cities.

We conducted one-hour in-depth interviews with 26 educational specialists, small and medium-sized businesses and NPO leaders across SEA.



# Glossary

## Educators

Content creators who teach or demonstrate to others a skill that they have, or share information on topics they are informed about.

## Learners

Users who watch TikTok for academic education, or to acquire new skills or information.

## Wellness Advocates

Content creators who speak about and advocate for causes surrounding digital and mental well-being.

## Digital Well-being

Navigating the internet safely, treating others with respect and kindness online and ensuring personal or mental well-being online.

## Secondary Cities

Sub-metropolitan centers with population sizes ranging from 10 to 50% of a country's largest city. (Definition from Cities Alliance[13]).

13. Source: Cities Alliance, The Systems of Secondary Cities: The neglected drivers of urbanizing economies, 2014 (https://documents1.worldbank.org/curated/en/400881468181444474/pdf/898610BRI0CIVI00Box385295B00PUBLIC0.pdf)